

Manure Management Plan

M J Hunt & Son — Upper Assendon Farm, Stonor, Henley-on-Thames, Oxfordshire RG9 6HE

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This plan should be completed and kept up to date before organic manures (muck, slurry) are applied to land, and reviewed at least annually.

NVZ status

Confirmed non-NVZ. Checked via the Environment Agency's Nitrate Vulnerable Zone map (2025–2028 designations) for the Stonor/Upper Assendon Farm area — none of the farmed land falls within an NVZ.

Storage capacity

No slurry is produced or stored on the farm, so no storage capacity calculation applies. All manure is solid farmyard manure (FYM). Breeding cows are wintered outdoors on turnips and require no housing or manure storage. The only manure produced is from young/fattening stock housed over winter: heifers (6–12 months) at Assendon, bull calves/steers (6–12 months) at Shenley Wood Farm, and ~60 fattening cattle (20–30 months) at Coxlease (a location within the Upper Assendon Farm holding). This manure is stored as field heaps, not in a building or lagoon.

Where manure can/cannot be applied

The farm has no ditches or watercourses on it, so there are no water-proximity exclusion areas to map. Field heaps are relocated to a different field each year rather than reused on the same site, reducing nutrient build-up and runoff risk. Standard good practice (avoiding waterlogged, flooded, or frozen ground) is still followed for spreading.

Factors considered before each application

- NVZ restrictions and closed periods
- Soil type and condition (not waterlogged, flooded, snow-covered, or frozen for more than 12 hours in the previous 24)
- Crop nutrient requirement and slope
- Weather conditions and forecast
- Location of any wells, boreholes and abstraction points on this or neighbouring land (the farm itself has no watercourses or ditches, confirmed 24 Sep 2026 -- no on-farm water-proximity exclusion zones apply)

Review

This plan should be reviewed at least annually and whenever storage capacity or spreading area changes.